

Banking Fragility and the Capitalization Dilemma¹

Online Appendix

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A Empirical robustness and additional figures

This appendix section provides additional empirical evidence for the results in Section 2 of the main text. We report the annual IRF omitted from the main text, the three non-main productivity-shock IRF variants, and detailed baseline coefficient paths.

A.1 Additional IRFs

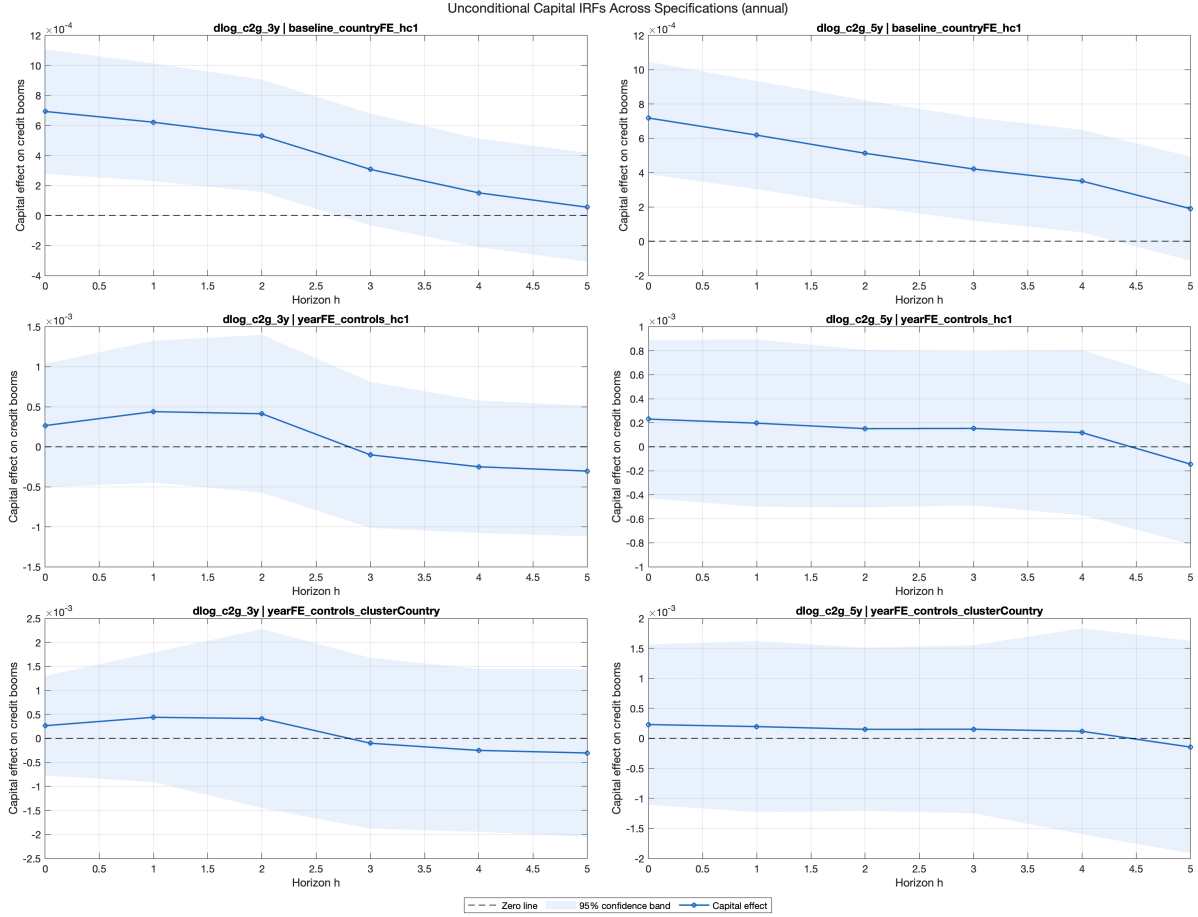


Figure A.1: Annual IRF: response of credit-boom measures to lagged capital ratios
Notes: Annual-horizon counterpart to the cumulative IRF shown in the main text.

A.2 Detailed robustness tables

B Model derivations

This appendix provides detailed derivations of the model's optimality conditions and equilibrium characterization.

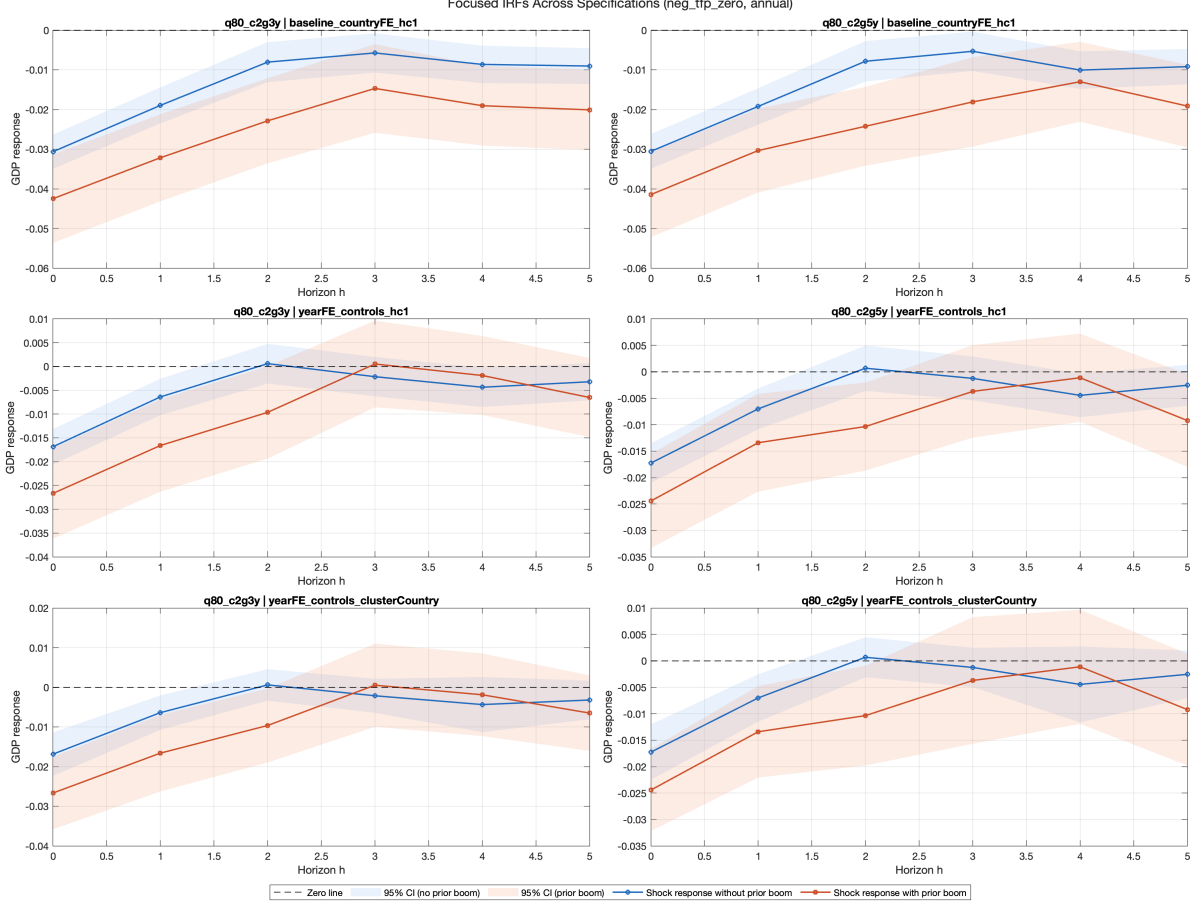


Figure A.2: Annual IRF: output response interaction (negative TFP defined as below zero)
 Notes: Annual-horizon interaction estimates between negative TFP shocks and pre-shock credit-boom state.

B.1 Bank's problem

The bank maximizes its franchise value:

$$\begin{aligned}
 J(n; X) = \max_{n'} & \pi(n; X) + n - n' \\
 & + (1 - \mathcal{H}(X)) \mathbb{E} q(X, X') J(n'; X') \\
 & + \mathcal{H}(X) \mathbb{E} q(X, X') J((1 - \varphi)n'; X')
 \end{aligned} \tag{1}$$

where bank profit is:

$$\pi(n; X) = \max_l \Phi(l) (R^K(X) - 1) - (R^B(X) - 1)(l - n) \tag{2}$$

subject to the leverage constraint $b := l - n \leq \phi_0 + \phi_1 n$.

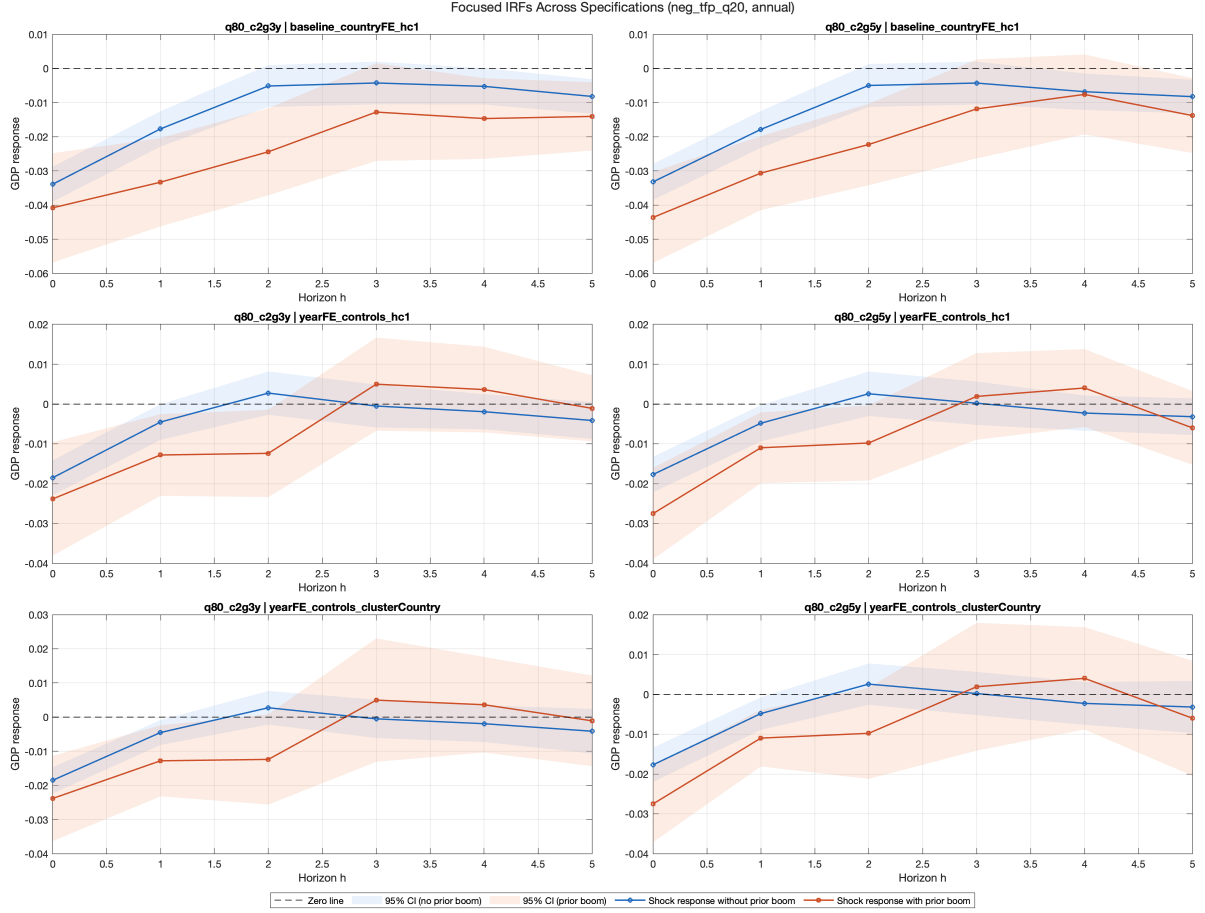


Figure A.3: Annual IRF: output response interaction (negative TFP defined as bottom quintile)
Notes: Alternative shock definition using the lower 20th percentile of TFP growth.

Intratemporal lending FOC. The first-order condition for optimal lending l is:

$$\Phi'(l)(R^K(X) - 1) = (R^B(X) - 1) + \lambda \quad (3)$$

where $\lambda \geq 0$ is the multiplier on the leverage constraint, with complementary slackness:

$$\lambda \geq 0, \quad l - n \leq \phi_0 + \phi_1 n, \quad \lambda [\phi_0 + \phi_1 n - (l - n)] = 0 \quad (4)$$

With $\Phi(l) = \Phi_A l^{\Phi_B}$, we have $\Phi'(l) = \Phi_A \Phi_B l^{\Phi_B - 1}$. Solving for l :

$$l = \left(\frac{(R^B - 1) + \lambda}{\Phi_A \Phi_B (R^K - 1)} \right)^{1/(\Phi_B - 1)} \quad (5)$$

Intertemporal Euler equation. The first-order condition for n' is:

$$1 = (1 - \mathcal{H}(X)) \mathbb{E} [q(X, X') J_1(n'; X')] + \mathcal{H}(X) (1 - \varphi) \mathbb{E} [q(X, X') J_1((1 - \varphi)n'; X')] \quad (6)$$

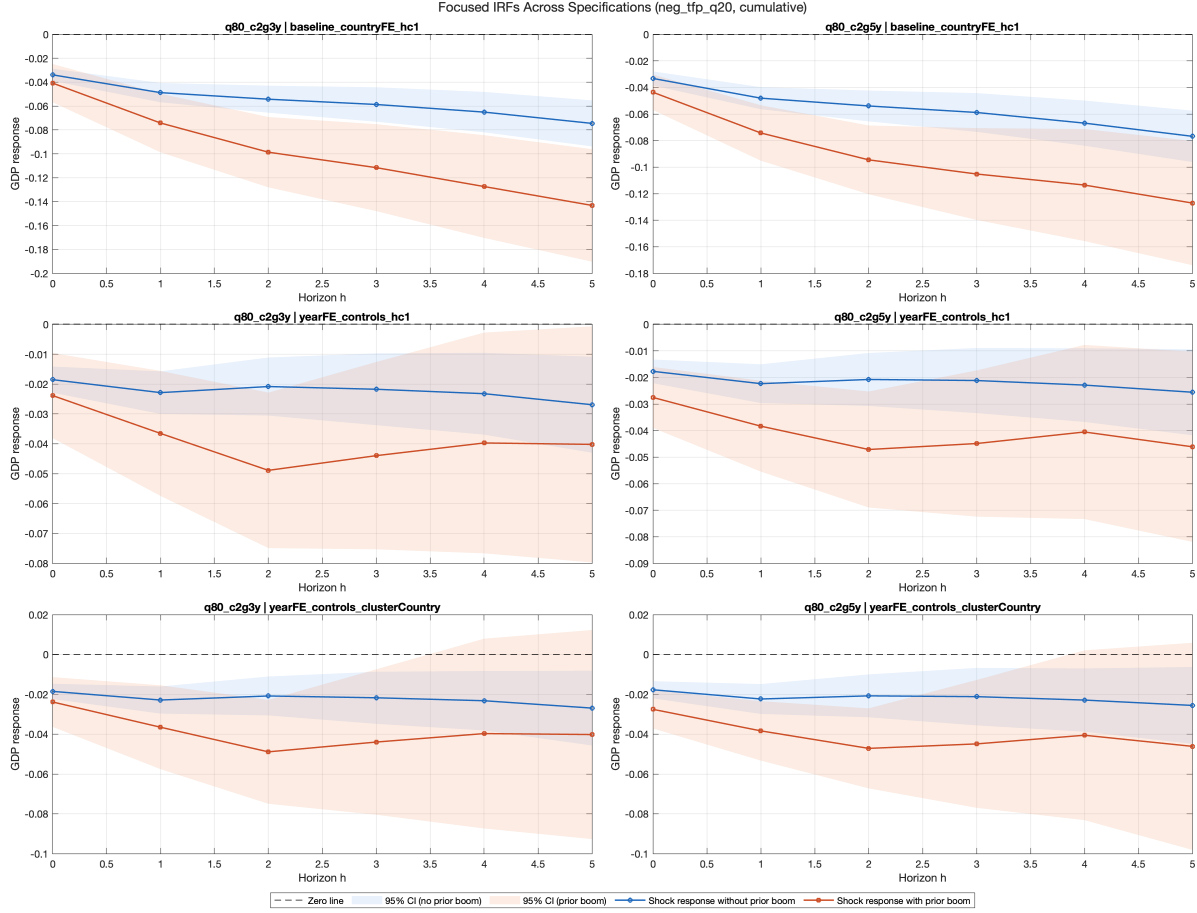


Figure A.4: Cumulative IRF: output response interaction (negative TFP defined as bottom quintile)
Notes: Cumulative-horizon counterpart to Figure A.3.

The $(1 - \varphi)$ factor on the second branch arises from the chain rule applied to $J((1 - \varphi)n')$.

Envelope condition. Since the profit subproblem above includes the leverage constraint, the envelope theorem applied to its Lagrangian $\mathcal{L} = \Phi(l)(R^K - 1) - (R^B - 1)(l - n) + \lambda[\phi_0 + \phi_1 n - (l - n)]$ gives

$$\frac{\partial \pi}{\partial n} = (R^B(X) - 1) + \lambda(1 + \phi_1),$$

where $(R^B - 1)$ is the direct effect of n on deposit costs and $\lambda(1 + \phi_1)$ is the shadow value of the constraint slackening: one more unit of n relaxes $l - n \leq \phi_0 + \phi_1 n$ by $(1 + \phi_1)$ units. (The indirect effect through l^* vanishes at the optimum by the lending FOC.) Adding the $+1$ from $\partial n / \partial n$ in the dividend expression $\pi + n - n'$,

$$J_1(n; X) = \frac{\partial \pi}{\partial n} + 1 = R^B(X) + \lambda(1 + \phi_1). \quad (7)$$

Table A.1: Cumulative LP coefficients: credit boom on lagged capital ratio

Horizon	Coefficient	Std. error	p-value	95% CI low	95% CI high
<i>Panel A. Baseline design (i): country fixed effects, HC1 inference</i>					
0	0.00069	0.00021	0.001	0.00028	0.00111
1	0.00125	0.00038	0.001	0.00051	0.00200
2	0.00163	0.00051	0.001	0.00063	0.00263
3	0.00177	0.00061	0.004	0.00057	0.00297
4	0.00175	0.00071	0.013	0.00037	0.00313
5	0.00165	0.00080	0.039	0.00008	0.00321
<i>Panel B. Most conservative design (iii): country and year fixed effects, lagged controls, country-clustered inference</i>					
0	0.00027	0.00049	0.595	-0.00077	0.00130
1	0.00067	0.00112	0.554	-0.00169	0.00304
2	0.00103	0.00201	0.617	-0.00324	0.00529
3	0.00089	0.00282	0.755	-0.00508	0.00686
4	0.00061	0.00356	0.866	-0.00694	0.00817
5	0.00034	0.00433	0.938	-0.00884	0.00952

Notes: Cumulative response of 3-year credit-to-GDP growth to the lagged aggregate capital ratio, by horizon. Panel A reports the baseline design (i) of the main text (country fixed effects with HC1 inference), under which the estimates are positive and statistically significant at every horizon. Panel B reports the most conservative design (iii), adding year fixed effects and lagged controls with country-clustered standard errors, under which the estimates retain their sign but lose significance. The main text reads the pattern as robust in sign but sensitive to specification.

Table A.2: Baseline cumulative LP interaction coefficients: negative TFP $\times$ prior credit boom

Horizon	Interaction	Std. error	p-value	95% CI low	95% CI high
0	-0.01184	0.00613	0.054	-0.02387	0.00019
1	-0.02707	0.01023	0.008	-0.04714	-0.00700
2	-0.04330	0.01334	0.001	-0.06948	-0.01712
3	-0.05399	0.01634	0.001	-0.08605	-0.02194
4	-0.06448	0.01929	0.001	-0.10232	-0.02664
5	-0.07535	0.02165	0.001	-0.11783	-0.03286

Notes: Baseline design (i) of the main text: country fixed effects with HC1 inference. Shock definition uses negative TFP realizations below zero and a high-credit-boom pre-shock state (top-quintile 3-year credit growth).

B.2 Firm's problem

The firm maximizes:

$$\max_{K, H^D} AK^\alpha (H^D)^{1-\alpha} - (R^K + \delta - 1)K - w(X)H^D \quad (8)$$

With $\delta = 1$, the first-order conditions are:

$$R^K = \alpha AK^{\alpha-1}(H^D)^{1-\alpha} \quad (9)$$

$$w(X) = (1 - \alpha)AK^\alpha(H^D)^{-\alpha} \quad (10)$$

B.3 Household's problem

The household maximizes:

$$v(a; X) = \max_{a', B, H^S} u(C, H^S) + \beta \mathbb{E} v(a'; X') \quad (11)$$

subject to:

$$C + p'(X)a' = p(X)a + (R^B(X) - 1)B + w(X)H^S - \zeta(B) \quad (12)$$

where $\zeta(B) = \zeta_1 B + \zeta_2 B^2$.

With GHH preferences $u = \log(C - \eta(H^S)^{1+1/\chi}/(1 + 1/\chi))$:

Labor supply.

$$H^S = \left(\frac{w(X)}{\eta} \right)^\chi \quad (13)$$

Deposit rate. The FOC for B gives:

$$R^B(X) = 1 + \zeta'(B) = 1 + \zeta_1 + 2\zeta_2 B \quad (14)$$

Stochastic discount factor. The Euler equation for equity holdings gives:

$$q(X, X') = \beta \frac{u_c(C', H^{S'})}{u_c(C, H^S)} \quad (15)$$

With log-GHH utility ($\gamma = 1$), $u_c = 1/\tilde{C}$ where $\tilde{C} = C - \eta(H^S)^{1+1/\chi}/(1 + 1/\chi)$, so:

$$q(X, X') = \beta \frac{\tilde{C}(X)}{\tilde{C}(X')} \quad (16)$$

with current-period composite consumption in the numerator and next-period in the denominator.

Labor market equilibrium. Substituting labor demand $w = (1 - \alpha)AK^\alpha H^{-\alpha}$ into labor supply $H = (w/\eta)^\chi$ and solving:

$$H = \left(\frac{(1 - \alpha)AK^\alpha}{\eta} \right)^{1/(1/\chi + \alpha)} \quad (17)$$

B.4 Equilibrium conditions

Market clearing.

$$\text{Lending: } L(X) = l(N; X) \quad (18)$$

$$\text{Capital: } \Phi(L(X)) = K(X) \quad (19)$$

$$\text{Deposits: } B = b(N; X) = L - N \quad (20)$$

$$\text{Equity: } a = 1 \quad (21)$$

$$\text{Labor: } H^S = H^D =: H \quad (22)$$

$$\text{Asset price: } p(X) = J(N; X) \quad (23)$$

Aggregate equity transition.

$$N'(X) = \begin{cases} n'(N; X) & \text{with prob. } 1 - \mathcal{H}(X) \\ (1 - \varphi) n'(N; X) & \text{with prob. } \mathcal{H}(X) \end{cases} \quad (24)$$

National accounting identity.

$$Y = C + \xi(B) + K + (n' - N) \quad (25)$$

stated in terms of the bank's *chosen* retention n' (the object entering the dividend $D = \pi + N - n'$). The identity holds every period: no goods are destroyed contemporaneously by a failure. The failure shock realizes between periods, mapping n' into realized equity $N' = (1 - \varphi)n'$; the destroyed wedge $\varphi n'$ is rebated to no one and is a loss of the wealth stock carried into the next period, whose real cost accrues going forward through lower intermediation, capital, and output. Bank failures therefore destroy aggregate resources in present value even though the current-period goods market clears.

Derivation of the national accounting identity. Under competitive factor markets with CRS and full depreciation: $Y = R^K K + wH$ (factor payments exhaust output). From the household budget constraint, aggregate consumption is:

$$C = wH + (R^B - 1)B + D - \xi(B)$$

where $D = \pi + N - n'$ is the aggregate dividend, n' is the bank's chosen retention, and bank profit is $\pi = (R^K - 1)K - (R^B - 1)B$. Substituting:

$$\begin{aligned} C &= wH + (R^K - 1)K + N - n' - \xi(B) \\ &= (Y - K) + N - n' - \xi(B) \end{aligned}$$

Rearranging yields the identity (25):

$$Y = C + \xi(B) + K + (n' - N).$$

B.5 Social planner's problem

The constrained social planner maximizes the representative household's lifetime utility:

$$\max_{\{n'_t, l_t\}_{t \geq 0}} \mathbb{E}_0 \sum_{t=0}^{\infty} \beta^t u(C_t, H_t) \quad (26)$$

subject to: (i) the intermediation technology $K_t = \Phi(l_t)$; (ii) the leverage constraint $l_t - n_t \leq \phi_0 + \phi_1 n_t$; (iii) the factor markets (equations (9)–(10)); (iv) the hazard function $\mathcal{H}_t = \sigma(\kappa_1 N_t / L_t + \kappa_0)$; (v) the aggregate equity transition; and (vi) the resource constraint. Crucially, the planner recognizes that the lending choice l_t affects the current-period hazard through $L_t = l_t$ in equilibrium, and that the equity choice n'_t affects next-period hazard through N_{t+1} .

The key difference from the competitive equilibrium is that the planner's intratemporal lending FOC internalizes $\partial \mathcal{H} / \partial l \neq 0$. Since $L = N + B$ and $B = l - n$, choosing more lending raises deposits, increasing leverage and the hazard rate. This generates a deposit-margin wedge $\tau(X)$ on the lending FOC (intra-temporal margin) and, through the envelope condition, an equity-margin wedge $\nu(X) = \tau(X) L / N$ in the marginal value of equity (inter-temporal margin).

Modified Euler equation. The planner's Euler equation adds a Pigouvian wedge:

$$1 = (1 - \mathcal{H}) \mathbb{E} \left[q J_1^{\text{SPP}}(n'; X') \right] + \mathcal{H} (1 - \varphi) \mathbb{E} \left[q J_1^{\text{SPP}}((1 - \varphi)n'; X') \right] \quad (27)$$

where the planner's marginal value of equity carries the equity-margin wedge ν (derived in the Proof of Proposition 1):

$$J_1^{\text{SPP}}(n; X) = R^B(X) + \lambda(1 + \phi_1) + \nu(X), \quad \nu(X) = \tau(X) \frac{L}{N}. \quad (28)$$

The deposit-margin Pigouvian object $\tau(X)$ enters the lending first-order condition directly (below), while the equity envelope carries the larger wedge $\nu = \tau L / N$.

Pigouvian tax.

$$\tau(X) = \frac{\beta}{u_c(C, H^S)} \cdot \frac{\partial \mathcal{H}}{\partial B} \cdot \mathbb{E} [V(n'; X') - V((1 - \varphi)n'; X')] \quad (29)$$

The derivative of the hazard with respect to deposits is:

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{H}}{\partial B} = \kappa_1 \cdot \mathcal{H}(1 - \mathcal{H}) \cdot \frac{\partial(N/L)}{\partial B} = \kappa_1 \cdot \mathcal{H}(1 - \mathcal{H}) \cdot \left(-\frac{N}{L^2}\right) \quad (30)$$

Since $\kappa_1 < 0$ and $-N/L^2 < 0$, we have $\partial \mathcal{H} / \partial B > 0$: higher deposits (more leverage) increase the failure hazard. Since $V(n') > V((1 - \varphi)n')$, the Pigouvian tax is positive ($\tau > 0$), inducing the planner to choose lower leverage.

Modified lending FOC.

$$\Phi'(l)(R^K - 1) - (R^B - 1) = \lambda + \tau \quad (31)$$

The positive τ acts as an additional cost of leverage, reducing the planner's lending relative to the decentralized equilibrium.

C Proofs

Proof of Proposition 1. The deposit-margin Pigouvian wedge is $\tau(X) = (\beta/u_c) \cdot (\partial \mathcal{H} / \partial B) \cdot \mathbb{E}[V(n'; X') - V((1 - \varphi)n'; X')]$. Each factor is signed as follows. (i) $\beta/u_c > 0$. (ii) $\partial \mathcal{H} / \partial B = \kappa_1 \mathcal{H}(1 - \mathcal{H})(-N/L^2) > 0$, since $\kappa_1 < 0$ and $-N/L^2 < 0$, so the product of two negatives is positive. (iii) $V(n'; X') - V((1 - \varphi)n'; X') > 0$ for $\varphi > 0$, provided the equilibrium value function V is strictly increasing in aggregate bank equity. We treat this monotonicity as a maintained hypothesis and verify it in the computed solution (V is strictly increasing in N over the entire state space); the economics behind it is that higher equity both expands the feasible set (any allocation attainable at lower equity remains attainable, with the difference paid out to the household) and strictly lowers the failure hazard. Therefore $\tau > 0$. The marginal social value of equity is obtained from the planner's envelope condition: differentiating the planner's value with respect to aggregate equity and substituting the lending optimality condition $\Phi'(L)(R^K - 1) - (R^B - 1) = \lambda + \tau$ yields $J_1^{\text{SPP}} = R^B + \lambda(1 + \phi_1) + \nu$, where the equity-margin wedge $\nu = \tau(L/N)$ scales the deposit-margin wedge by the balance-sheet-to-equity ratio (equity both lowers the hazard directly and supports safe intermediation, so its social value carries the full balance sheet L relative to equity N). Since $L/N > 1$, we have $\nu > \tau > 0$, so $J_1^{\text{SPP}} = R^B + \lambda(1 + \phi_1) + \nu > J_1^{\text{CE}} = R^B + \lambda(1 + \phi_1)$ at a common allocation: the planner's Euler equation requires a higher expected marginal value of equity than the competitive bank's. Whether this translates into strictly higher retention at every state depends on the curvature of the value function; in the calibrated solution the planner's optimal policy does retain more equity at every state, $n^{\text{SPP}} > n^{\text{CE}}$. ■

Proof of Proposition 2. The conditional steady state under frozen regime A is a fixed point of $n'(\cdot; A)$. By assumption, $n'(N; A) > N$ for small N (precautionary savings and high marginal returns push equity upward from low levels) and $n'(N; A) < N$ for large N (dividend extraction eventually dominates). Continuity of $n'(\cdot; A)$ and the intermediate value theorem guarantee existence of a fixed point N_A^{CS} satisfying $n'(N_A^{\text{CS}}; A) = N_A^{\text{CS}}$. If $n'(\cdot; A)$ crosses the 45-degree line exactly once, the fixed point is unique. Global stability uses the additional hypothesis that $n'(\cdot; A)$ is nondecreasing (as in the computed policy functions): for any $N_0 < N_A^{\text{CS}}$, single crossing gives $n'(N_0; A) > N_0$, and monotonicity gives $n'(N_0; A) \leq n'(N_A^{\text{CS}}; A) = N_A^{\text{CS}}$, so the forward orbit $\{N_t\}$ is increasing and bounded above by N_A^{CS} ; it therefore converges, and by continuity its limit is a fixed point, hence N_A^{CS} . The argument for $N_0 > N_A^{\text{CS}}$ is symmetric. Without monotonicity the orbit could overshoot the fixed point and cycle, so the nondecreasing hypothesis is not dispensable. ■

Proof of Proposition 3. By hypothesis—which Proposition 1 shows holds in the calibrated solution— $n^{\text{SPP}}(N; A) > n^{\text{CE}}(N; A)$ for all N , so the SPP policy function lies strictly above the CE policy function. Since both are continuous and, under the single-crossing hypothesis of Proposition 2, cross the 45-degree line exactly once, the SPP crossing occurs at a strictly higher N : $N_A^{\text{CS,SPP}} > N_A^{\text{CS,CE}}$. ■

D Steady state characterization

The deterministic steady state is computed under the assumption of zero failure probability ($\mathcal{H} = 0$). This serves as the initial guess for the RTM iteration; the stochastic equilibrium then endogenously determines positive hazard rates.

Deposit rate. From the Euler equation with $\mathcal{H} = 0$ and $\lambda = 0$: $1 = \beta R^B$, so $R_{\text{ss}}^B = 1/\beta$.

Deposits. From the deposit rate equation (14):

$$B_{\text{ss}} = \frac{1/\beta - 1 - \zeta_1}{2\zeta_2} \quad (32)$$

Capital. The steady-state capital is determined by equating the firm-implied return on capital (from (9)) with the bank-implied return (from the lending FOC (3) with $\lambda = 0$):

$$\alpha AK^{\alpha-1}H(K)^{1-\alpha} = \frac{R^B - 1}{\Phi'(L(K))} + 1 \quad (33)$$

where $H(K)$ is given by (17) and $L(K)$ is obtained by inverting $K = \Phi_A L^{\Phi_B}$.

Table D.3 reports the deterministic steady-state values under the baseline calibration.

Table D.3: Deterministic Steady State

Variable	Symbol	Value
Output	Y	0.3340
Consumption	C	0.2267
Capital	K	0.1064
Labor	H	0.5867
Bank equity	N	0.0413
Deposits	B	0.0417
Loans	L	0.0829
Capital ratio	N/L	0.4975
Return on capital	R^K	1.0361
Deposit rate	R^B	1.0417
Bank profit	π	0.0021
Wage	w	0.3814
Franchise value	J	0.0526
Hazard rate	$\mathcal{H}$	0.0501

Notes: Deterministic steady state computed imposing $\mathcal{H} = 0$ and $\lambda = 0$ in decisions. The hazard-rate row reports the hazard function *evaluated at* the steady-state capital ratio $N/L = 0.4975$ —the $\approx 5\%$ calibration target—not a hazard imposed in the steady-state computation.

E Sensitivity analysis

Table E.4 reports the sensitivity of key model outcomes to $\pm 25\%$ perturbations of five parameters: the hazard slope κ_1 , the distress recovery loss φ , the intermediation curvature Φ_B , the leverage slope ϕ_1 , and the deposit cost ζ_2 . For each perturbation, the model is re-solved from scratch (steady state plus full RTM iteration), and we report the steady-state capital ratio N_{ss}/L_{ss} , the mean ergodic hazard rate $\bar{\mathcal{H}}$, the fraction of periods where the leverage constraint binds, output volatility $\sigma(Y)$, and mean bank equity $\bar{N}$.

F Computational details

F.1 RTM algorithm

The Repeated Transition Method (RTM) solves the model by iterating on a simulated equilibrium path of length $T = 5,001$ periods, the first $\text{BURNIN} = 500$ of which are discarded when computing statistics. Each iteration consists of:

1. **Backward step (Euler inversion):** For each period t and TFP state A_t , find the bank's optimal equity choice n'_t by inverting the Euler equation (6). State-contingent expectations are computed using iso-shock matching: for each future TFP state A' , identify periods on the current path where $A = A'$ and interpolate allocations at the target equity level n'_t (or $(1 - \varphi)n'_t$ for the run branch).

Table E.4: Sensitivity Analysis

Parameter	Value	N_{ss}/L_{ss}	$\bar{\mathcal{H}}$	Binding (%)	$\sigma(Y)$	$\bar{N}$
κ_1	-5.1450	0.4975	0.1836	31.9	0.0382	0.0293
κ_1	-6.8600 [†]	0.4975	0.0887	17.8	0.0311	0.0334
κ_1	-8.5750	0.4975	0.0373	9.5	0.0256	0.0374
φ	0.4500	0.4975	0.0895	18.2	0.0253	0.0334
φ	0.6000 [†]	0.4975	0.0887	17.8	0.0311	0.0334
φ	0.7500	0.4975	0.0993	25.2	0.0408	0.0316
Φ_B	0.6750		<i>failed to converge</i>			
Φ_B	0.9000 [†]	0.4975	0.0887	17.8	0.0311	0.0334
Φ_B	1.1250	0.6886	0.0344	0.0	0.2551	0.2933
ϕ_1	1.1250	0.4975	0.0658	19.8	0.0298	0.0372
ϕ_1	1.5000 [†]	0.4975	0.0887	17.8	0.0311	0.0334
ϕ_1	1.8750	0.4975	0.1117	19.3	0.0316	0.0302
ζ_2	0.3750	0.3300	0.1107	31.6	0.0356	0.0295
ζ_2	0.5000 [†]	0.4975	0.0887	17.8	0.0311	0.0334
ζ_2	0.6250	0.5980	0.0645	11.6	0.0275	0.0388

Notes: Each parameter is varied by $\pm 25\%$ around its baseline ([†]). $\bar{\mathcal{H}}$: mean ergodic hazard rate. Binding: fraction of periods where the leverage constraint binds. $\sigma(Y)$: output volatility. $\bar{N}$: mean bank equity. The +25% perturbation of Φ_B (to 1.125) lies outside the concave region $\Phi_B < 1$ maintained by the model—the bank’s problem is then convex in lending, so the reported row should be read as a mechanical solver output far outside the theory’s domain rather than a comparable economy (its outlier moments reflect this). The -25% perturbation does not converge.

2. **Forward step (simulation):** Given the consumption path implied by the backward step’s Euler inversion, simulate the economy forward. The forward step determines: (a) the equity choice n'_t residually from the national accounting identity, given consumption and the current allocations (consistent with the Euler-inverted consumption of step 1); (b) run realization from Bernoulli($\mathcal{H}_t$) using fixed uniform draws; (c) factual equity N_{t+1} from the run/no-run outcome.
3. **Damping:** Update allocations as $x^{\text{new}} = \omega x^{\text{old}} + (1 - \omega)x^{\text{forward}}$ with $\omega = 0.999$ for equity and $\omega = 0.99$ for consumption, deposits, and the constraint multiplier.
4. **Convergence:** The algorithm terminates when $\text{MSE}(x^{\text{old}}, x^{\text{forward}}) < 10^{-8}$.

F.2 GIRF computation

The GIRF is computed by forward-simulating the economy from a given initial state (N_0, A_0) using the converged policy functions, averaged over 1,000 Monte Carlo paths. The initial equity N_0 is set to the 10th or 90th percentile of the ergodic distribution of N .

For the TFP shock GIRF, the shocked path starts in recession ($A_0 = A_L$) and the no-shock path starts in expansion ($A_0 = A_H$). From period 1 onward, both paths draw independently from the Markov transition matrix Π_A , while sharing the same uniform draws for run realizations to reduce Monte Carlo variance.

For the hazard shock GIRF, both paths share the same realized TFP sequence. The shocked path forces a bank failure at $t = 1$; the no-shock path forces no failure. From $t \geq 2$, both paths use shared uniform draws for run realizations, ensuring that differences in hazard outcomes arise solely from the endogenous difference in equity levels.